ODISSEI Annual Plan 2027

What the Dutch national infrastructure for social science will build, run and measure in 2027.



€10.26M
Planned expenditure

4
Workstreams

3
Projects: SSHOC-NL, Macroscope, PDI-SSH

44
Member organisations

Message from the Chair



Daniel Oberski

Scientific Director & Chair of the Management Board

> **Researchers should be able to concentrate on their scientific questions, with confidence that sensitive data are handled responsibly.**

The plans for 2027 are very exciting, particularly the prospect of bringing different ways of studying society into the same research workflow. Surveys, digital traces, experiments, historical collections and population networks each reveal something different. Connecting them gives us opportunities to ask questions that none of these sources could answer alone.

The developments around LISS are a compelling example. Integrating data donation, interactive experiments and mobile measurements with a probability-based panel opens up new possibilities for understanding everyday behaviour. Connecting participants' media use to the content they encounter could help us investigate how information, attitudes and social circumstances interact. This is where collaboration between the social sciences and humanities becomes scientifically productive.

Of course, more data do not automatically produce better knowledge. We still need to establish what our measures capture, whose experiences are represented, and where uncertainty enters our conclusions. I see an important role for our infrastructure in making that methodological work possible, alongside providing access to new sources and computational tools.

In 2027, we will also work to make those possibilities more accessible. Further development of SANE and the Data Access Broker will help connect discovery, permission and secure analysis. Researchers should be able to concentrate on their scientific questions, with confidence that sensitive data are handled responsibly.

Equally encouraging is the investment in people such as research software engineers, methodological support, fellowships and training. Infrastructure becomes useful through the expertise of colleagues who help researchers design studies, solve problems and develop approaches that others can reuse.

Our ambition is substantial, and delivery will require careful choices and sustained collaboration. I look forward to seeing these connections take shape in research projects, and to working with our partners to build an infrastructure whose value is demonstrated in the quality of the research it enables across our disciplines.

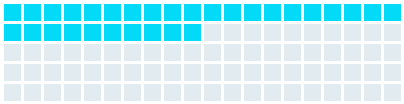
2027 at a glance

€10,264,417

Sum of the four workstream budgets

Data Facility

€3,052,182
30% of total

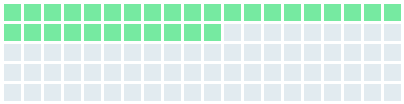


Some of the most valuable social science data are also the most sensitive. The Data Facility makes it possible for researchers to find such data, request access, and analyse it in a protected setting where the data owner stays in control.

- Access in about two weeks instead of three to four
- OSSC opened to a first provider beyond CBS
- FIRMBACKBONE from request to workspace by spring

Observatory

€3,175,226
31% of total

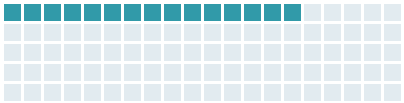


The Observatory sustains the long-running data collections the community relies on and opens up kinds of data that did not exist a few years ago.

- PANL opens its public beta
- First wave of the Web & Media Diets Observatory
- First shared question bank for international surveys

Laboratory

€1,494,504
15% of total

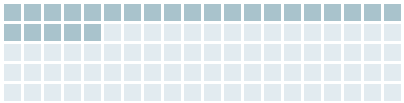


The Laboratory develops shared tools that let researchers study digital traces and social networks responsibly, so research groups can build on common tools instead of creating their own.

- D3I becomes a full service
- Online experiments open to all researchers
- New methods for safer network research

Hub

€2,542,505
25% of total



Data and tools matter only when researchers know they exist, can get help using them, and trust they are used responsibly. The Hub is where researchers find that help.

- Support measured from January
- One process for every access grant
- An Ethics Forum with a public voice

Why ODISSEI matters

ODISSEI gives social scientists in the Netherlands shared access to data, secure computing, tools and expertise that individual institutions would otherwise have to organise for themselves. ODISSEI has 44 member organisations. In 2027, much of this work is carried out through three projects, SSHOC-NL, Macroscope and PDI-SSH, which are coordinated as joint SSH-RI task plans with CLARIAH. This plan describes the work through ODISSEI's four workstreams: the Data Facility, the Observatory, the Laboratory and the Hub.

Many research questions about Dutch society depend on data that are sensitive, collected over long periods, or gathered in new ways. Examples are questions on inequality, ageing, education, labour markets, health and digital life. Working with such data requires secure environments, legal agreements, long-term data collection and specialised methods. ODISSEI provides these as shared services, so that researchers at member organisations can use them for their own projects.









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Secure access to sensitive data

CBS microdata, linked administrative records and digital trace data can only be analysed in protected environments. ODISSEI supports access to CBS microdata and offers SANE (Secure Analysis Environment) and the OSSC (ODISSEI Secure Supercomputer) for sensitive data from other providers, so that institutions do not each need to build their own. Data providers keep control over their data, and researchers follow one brokered process. The number of projects on SANE grew from 20 in mid-2025 to 67 in June 2026.

Finding and reusing data

The ODISSEI Portal, the knowledge graph and FAIR archiving at DANS help researchers find datasets, connect them, and keep results available for future research. The Portal holds metadata from 19 of ODISSEI's 27 scientific members and attracts more than 500 unique visitors a month.

Data collections that follow society over time

Questions about social mobility, ageing, inequality and family formation need data collected consistently over many years. ODISSEI supports collections that follow the same individuals, households and families over time, and collections that repeat the same questions with new samples to track trends. These include the LISS panel, which is representative of the Dutch population, and the Dutch participation in SHARE (Survey of Health, Ageing and Retirement in Europe), ESS (European Social Survey), EVS (European Values Study), WVS (World Values Survey) and GGP (Gender and Generation Programme), which allows comparison with other countries. PANL adds a flexible platform for fast participant recruitment, and historical records from the Historical Sample of the Netherlands extend the view across generations. The LISS Data Archive has more than 14,000 registered users, and 1,912 publications based on LISS data are known.

Tools for new types of data

Researchers increasingly need digital traces, behavioural data and experiments alongside surveys. Through data donation, mass online experiments and the Netherlands Media Corpus, ODISSEI offers shared tools for collecting digital trace data, running large interactive experiments and connecting survey answers with media content. These support research on topics such as social media, misinformation and online behaviour, without each project having to build its own tools.

Methods for population-scale analysis

PLANET-NL provides open-source software for analysing networks that cover the Dutch population and for assessing the risk that such data reveal individuals. This allows these methods to be used safely within secure environments.

Support, training and coordination

Infrastructure is only useful when researchers can use it with confidence. The Hub offers access grants, fellowships, consultations, ethical and legal guidance, and training such as the ODISSEI-SICSS Summer School. It also coordinates ODISSEI's work with CLARIAH, SURF, DANS, CBS and European partners.

The three projects currently run by ODISSEI have complementary roles: SSHOC-NL builds foundations, Macroscope extends what researchers can do with them, and PDI-SSH helps make the resulting services sustainable. Together they aim for better infrastructure, which supports better research and, through it, a better society.

SSHOC-NL
Builds the foundations

Macroscope
Extends what researchers can do

PDI-SSH
Makes the services sustainable

2,570,000
Minutes of LISS panel time, free for researchers

64,000
Interviews conducted by ODISSEI surveys

10,586
Datasets in the ODISSEI Portal

5,846
Portal searches in the last 12 months

1,953
Publications

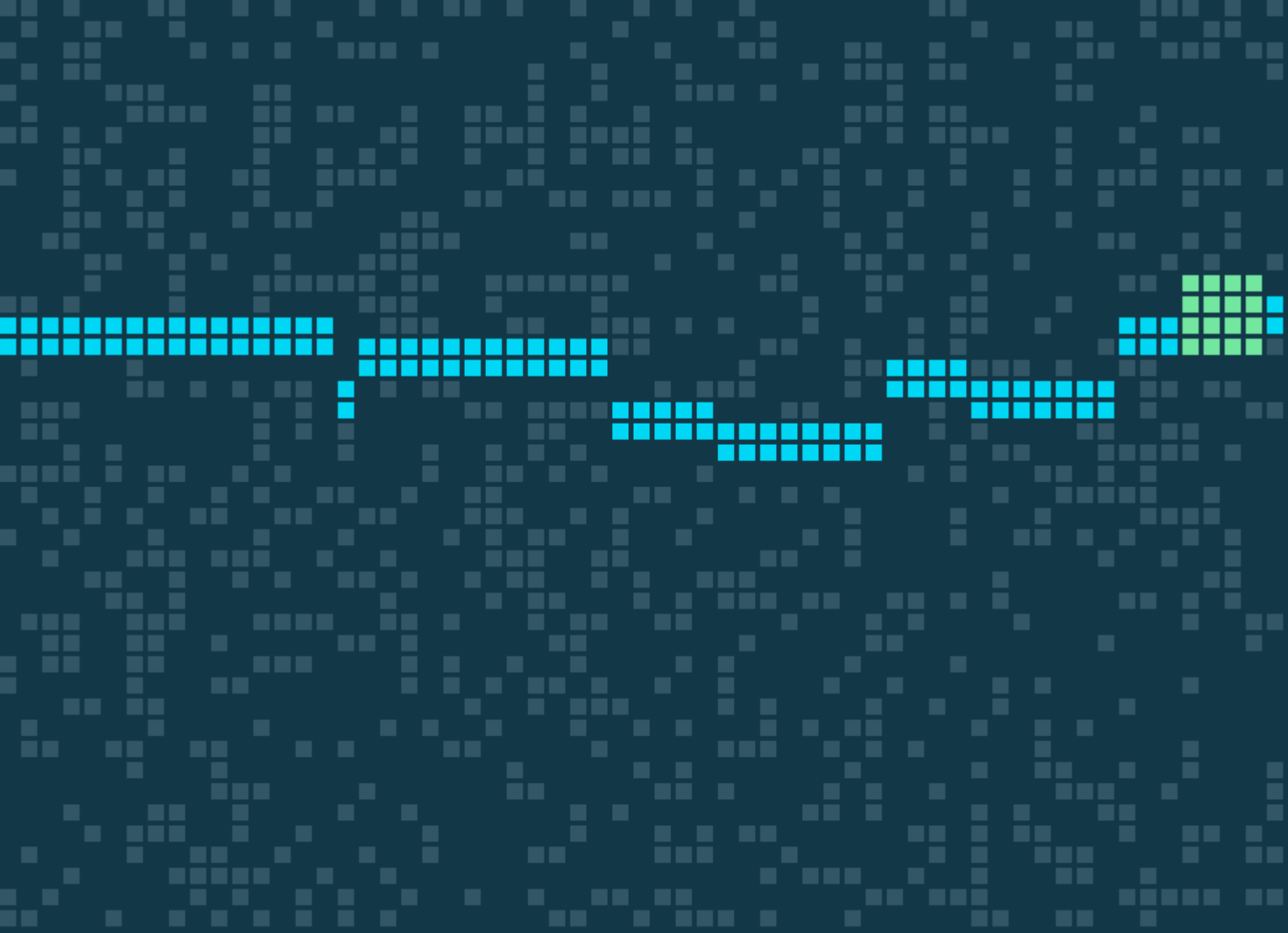
2,200
Attendees at events

651
CBS microdata projects financed

129
Summer School alumni

44
Member organisations

17
Projects on the Secure Supercomputer



Data Facility

From finding data to analysing it safely, in one route

Some of the most valuable social science data are also the most sensitive. The Data Facility makes it possible for researchers to find such data, request access, and analyse it in a protected setting where the data owner stays in control.

20 → 67
SANE research projects, against a target of 30

~2 weeks
Target time to access, down from three to four

€3,052,182
Budget 2027, 30% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€3,052,182

30% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

CBS microdata support

€478,696



Portal coverage and interoperability

€1,083,488



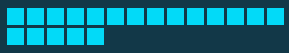
Secure computing on the OSSC

€523,337



SANE, incl. FIRMBACKBONE

€966,661



Planned 2027 expenditure is €3,052,182. This includes €478,696 allocated to CBS for continuous support in using the CBS microdata, while efforts to ensure interoperability and expand Portal coverage are budgeted at a total of €1,083,488. A total of €523,337 is allocated to secure computing via OSSC. In addition, €966,661 will be directed to improvements in SANE, both in terms of technical development and making Firmbackbone infrastructure accessible in this environment.

About the Data Facility

Some of the most valuable social science data are also the most sensitive: tax and income records, health information, and data about people's online behaviour. The Data Facility makes it possible for researchers to find such data, request access, and analyse it in a protected setting where the data owner stays in control.

The facility has several parts that work together. CBS provides access to its rich microdata. SANE is a secure online workspace where researchers can analyse data from many different providers. The OSSC offers protected computing power for complex analyses of CBS microdata. The ODISSEI Portal and the DANS archive help researchers discover datasets and ensure results are preserved for future use. A new tool, the Data Access Broker (DAB), handles access requests digitally, much like an online application form that knows each provider's rules. A Knowledge Graph (KG) supports this by connecting datasets, variables, access conditions, code, software, and publications, making it faster to find what researchers need and easier to reproduce research. In addition, ODISSEI supports data reuse through its FAIR Expertise Hub, which advises researchers and data providers on FAIR data practices.

2026 was a year of strong growth. The number of research projects using SANE more than tripled, from 20 to 67, far above the target of 30. Logging in became much easier, and the first data provider started handling requests through the Data Access Broker. In 2027, the aim is to join these pieces into one smooth route: a researcher finds a dataset, requests it, and receives a ready-to-use secure workspace, with access granted in about two weeks instead of the current three to four. The main challenge is to keep up with demand while building these new features.

Current status

20 → 67 research projects using SANE in 2026, against a target of 30

In 2026, microdata usage remained high, and facilities for finding and requesting data were further developed. At CBS, uploading large external datasets to the OSSC became simpler, and tools are being developed to make complex data easier to use and output checking more efficient. CBS is also piloting

synthetic “practice” versions of some datasets so researchers can prepare before using the real data. To support reuse and reproducibility, the FAIR Expertise Hub published a FAIR action plan, organised replication games with CBS data, and supported data providers and research projects.

The ODISSEI Portal became more stable, and a development plan was drafted. The Knowledge Graph now holds ODISSEI’s standard access conditions (based on the Five Safes Framework) in machine-readable form, and the new SSH FAIR Vocabulary Registry helps researchers find shared vocabularies. The DAB is moving from proof of concept to a first stable release, with FIRMBACKBONE as the first provider to test a complete request.

SANE became a service that researchers can use without specialist help. Use grew well beyond its target, including outside the social sciences, and researchers can now access their environment in a web browser. ODISSEI brokers between researchers, data providers and SURF, and in September 2026 introduced a fixed credit budget per project to keep costs predictable.

Future plans 2027

Easier-to-find and easier-to-use CBS data

CBS will issue its own persistent identifiers and publish its data catalogue, and will actively raise awareness of its facilities through events and communication with its users. It will start translating documentation into English, and introduce an application that checks research outputs faster and more transparently.

Secure computing beyond CBS

The OSSC will be upgraded and opened to a first data provider other than CBS. A prototype of a “federated” SANE, which analyses data where they are stored instead of moving them, will link SURF, the Netherlands Institute for Sound & Vision and the KB.

More and better features Each quarter

SANE will release improvements every quarter based on what researchers in current projects need, such as easier use of local AI language models, reopening closed projects to reproduce results, and better support for projects that combine data from several providers.

One secure route from search to analysis

Spring

An approved request should automatically create a secure workspace in SANE and deliver the data, without manual steps. FIRMBACKBONE, a dataset on Dutch companies, goes first (by spring), followed by the KB’s web archive collection.

A sustainable service June

The credit model for using SANE will be evaluated in June 2027, and the boards will receive a recommendation. Standard agreements for data providers will make onboarding quicker, and ODISSEI and SURF will agree by spring how international researchers can use SANE.

A richer Portal and archive

The Portal will extend its coverage to member organisations whose data are not yet included, improve search results, and connect more closely to the DAB so researchers can select and request multiple datasets at once.

Knowledge Graph development

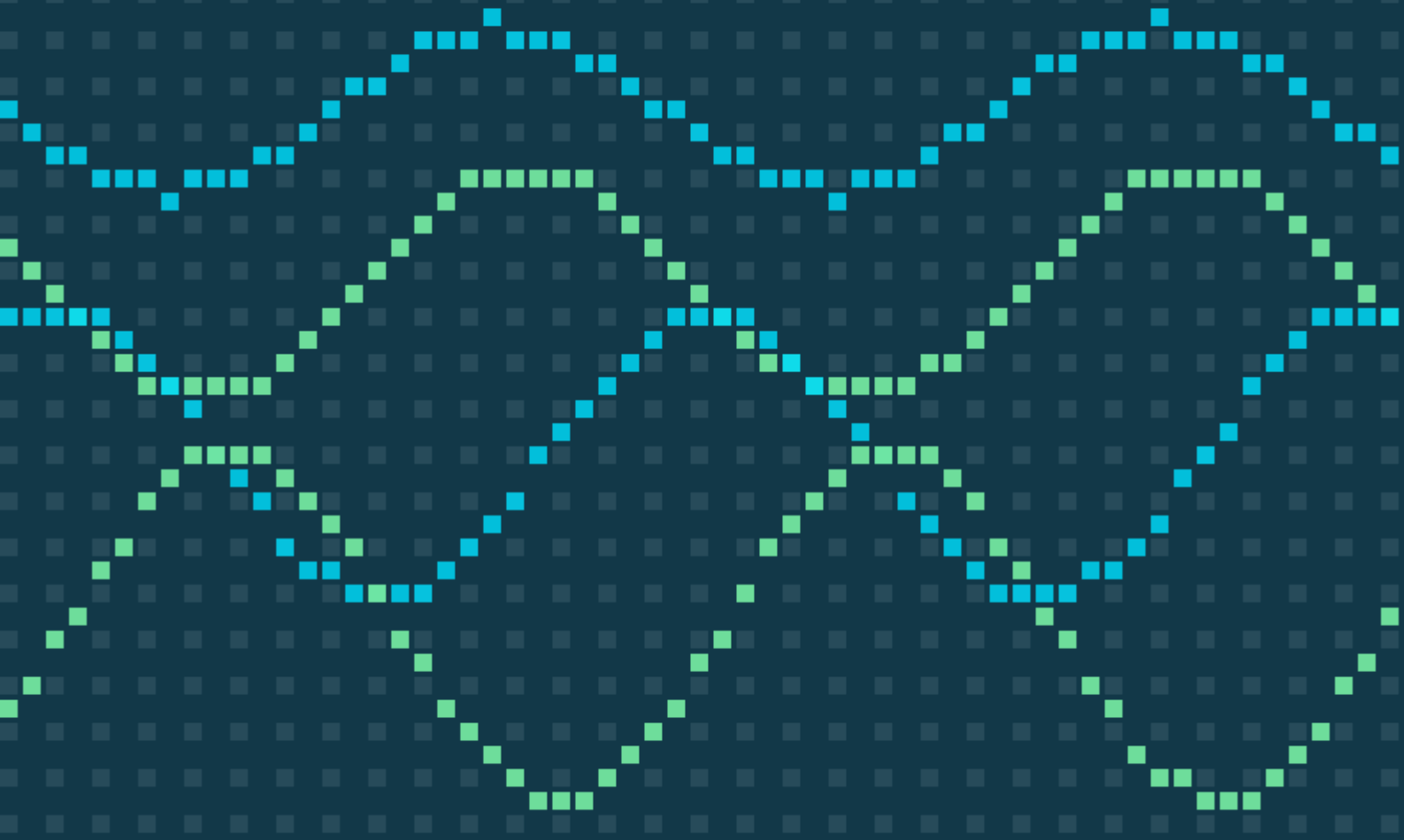
It will result in a roadmap and first prototypes. A pilot will connect the Knowledge Graph to the DAB and SANE, with records of data references, code, software, and access conditions for a study, so it can be reproduced in a secure environment in a few steps.

Consolidation in FAIR Expertise Hub

FAIR steward will help onboard more data providers to the secure data workflow of Portal, DAB and SANE, publish vocabularies that make data more FAIR, and continue its dissemination work through workshops and blogs.

European opportunities

The outcomes of two European proposals for SANE, TRELISS and FIERSE, are still pending; if funded, they would add development capacity and new users.



Observatory

Good research starts with good data

The Observatory sustains the long-running data collections the community relies on and opens up kinds of data that did not exist a few years ago.

7,500
People in 5,000 households in the LISS panel

14,000+
Registered users of the LISS Data Archive

€3,175,226
Budget 2027, 31% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€3,175,226

31% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

Data collections: international surveys

€773,953



Online panels: LISS and PANL

€1,882,410

incl. €216,410 PANL



Netherlands Media Corpus

€518,913



The planned 2027 expenditure for the Observatory is €3,175,226. Part of this total budget will be directed to data collections, to support international surveys and innovations, totalling €773,953. The investment in maintenance and improvements of Online Panels amounts to €1,882,410, including €216,410 for the launch and maintenance of PANL. The planned expenditure on the Netherlands Media Corpus is €518,913 for Web and Media diets collection and the first NMC pilots.

About the Observatory

Good research starts with good data, and ODISSEI delivers it. The workstream sustains the long-running data collections the community relies on and opens up kinds of data that did not exist a few years ago. It brings together three tasks: Data Collection, which secures Dutch participation in the major international surveys; Online Panels, home to the LISS panel and the new PANL platform; and the Netherlands Media Corpus, which turns the country's scattered media archives into a single resource for research.

For researchers at ODISSEI member organisations, this means free or low-cost access to some of the best data in Europe. The LISS panel offers a probability-based sample of around 7,500 people in 5,000 Dutch households (to be expanded in the Deepfield project), and every year the LISS ODISSEI calls fund new studies at no cost to the researcher. The SHARE, ESS, EVS and the Dutch Parliamentary Election Study provide a long view of Dutch society and place it alongside the rest of Europe. Through data donation, online experiments and mobile sensing, LISS now captures what people do as well as what they say.

Behind it all is one goal: data that can be found, linked, and analysed. Observatory data flows into the ODISSEI Portal for discovery and into SANE for secure analysis of sensitive material such as detailed geography or digital trace data. Soon, a researcher will be able to start from a survey answer, follow it to the news article a respondent read, and analyse both in one secure place.

2027 is the year these pieces start to connect. PANL opens its public beta version, giving researchers a fast, GDPR-compliant way to recruit Dutch-speaking participants and annotators, complementing the probability-based LISS panel. The Web & Media Diets Observatory fields its first full wave in LISS, recording which news and platforms people actually consume and linking that to the archived content itself at the KB National Library (KB) and other heritage institutions. And finally, the international surveys are moving toward cost-efficient, self-administered fieldwork, supported by a shared question bank, new sampling methods, and experiments to reach groups surveys usually miss.

Current status

1,912 known publications based on LISS data

In 2026, the Observatory ran at full strength while laying the foundations for the Macroscope project. The LISS panel recruited a new booster sample aimed at younger people, migrants and single-person households, moved to a mobile-first respondent portal, started building a mobile research app and added multilingual search to the LISS Data Archive. Data donation through Port is now a standard LISS feature; restricted LISS variables can be analysed in SANE. PANL completed its migration to the NEXT platform and entered a controlled soft launch.

For the international surveys, two Macroscope postdocs started at Utrecht University and Tilburg University; ESS, EVS and WVS tested self-administration in the LISS panel, and a question bank compatible with DCAT (Data Catalogue Vocabulary) and the ODISSEI Portal took shape, using LLMs to map overlap between questionnaires. The Netherlands Media Corpus team was hired at UvA and the KB, the corpus was scoped, and the Web & Media Diets Observatory was piloted in LISS together with the AlgoSoc project.

Future plans 2027

International studies continue

ODISSEI keeps the Netherlands in SHARE, funds national ESS coordination, and prepares for the Dutch Parliamentary Election Study at the next election.

Smarter, cheaper surveys

The first version of the shared question bank will be delivered, built from ESS, EVS, and other international questionnaires.

A strong, representative panel

LISS will continue to care for its panel and test new ways to recruit hard-to-reach groups. The annual LISS Core Study and the ODISSEI LISS panel call for research proposals will continue, and survey and media metadata will be registered in the ODISSEI Portal.

Reaching under-represented groups

Experiments to better reach under-represented groups are planned for the Dutch Parliamentary Election Study or SHARE, and for the ESS in 2028. Work on faster access to population samples will start.

Making study design easier

LISS panel will start developing a simple interface that helps researchers set up surveys and experiments and balance cost and quality.

Secure and FAIR by default

More sensitive LISS panel data, including GPS, accelerometer and digital-trace data, will become available through SANE.

Fast, flexible recruitment with PANL

PANL opens its public beta version to the wider ODISSEI community, and ODISSEI will run dedicated PANL calls to support usage. New features include booking and scheduling for offline studies and an environment for longer-term work with groups of annotators.

Linking people to the media they consume

The first wave of the Web & Media Diets Observatory will go live, covering at least two platforms. A new tool will let researchers retrieve archived web pages from the KB web collection by URL, and a proof-of-concept pipeline will ingest the news websites that respondents actually visited.

Frameworks for media usage research

A refined metadata model, a position paper on the Netherlands Media Corpus and a plan for audiovisual collections will be delivered. Pilot research projects will test two routes: from individuals to the content they saw, and from content in one archive to related content in others.



Laboratory

New tools for studying life in a digital, connected society

The Laboratory develops shared tools that let researchers study digital traces and social networks responsibly, so research groups can build on common tools instead of creating their own.

10
Data donation studies a year, the 2027 target

~160
Reuses a year of PLANET-NL's open-source software

€1,494,504
Budget 2027, 15% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€1,494,504

15% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

Data donation (D3I)

€697,597



Mass online experiments

€176,146



Large network tools (PLANET-NL)

€620,762



Planned 2027 expenditure is €1,494,504. Of this total budget, €697,597 will be allocated to upgrading the Data Donation facilities, ensuring the delivery of the D3I platform as a full service. Investments in mass online experiments will amount to €176,146, ensuring that the online experiments platform will be operational and ready for use. Finally, a budget of €620,762 will be allocated to securely leverage large network tools.

About the Laboratory

Much of everyday life now leaves digital traces, from the videos people watch to the messages they send. At the same time, researchers want to understand how people interact and how the networks of family, work, school and neighbourhood ties shape opportunities. The Laboratory develops shared tools that let researchers study these questions responsibly, so that research groups can build on common tools instead of creating their own for each project.

The Laboratory works on three areas. Data donation lets people voluntarily share the data that platforms such as Google, Instagram or TikTok hold about them, with full control over what they share. Mass online experiments allow thousands of people to take part in the same live, interactive study, for example, a group decision or a game of cooperation. Large network tools, developed by PLANET-NL (formerly POPNET), help researchers analyse networks that connect the entire Dutch population, using CBS data, while protecting people's privacy.

In 2026, researchers in the Netherlands gained free access to the data donation software, and data donation studies can now be set up without writing code. The first large online experiment was completed, and PLANET-NL released software that checks whether network data could reveal someone's identity. In 2027, the focus is on renewing, connecting and opening up these tools: a major upgrade of the data donation software, links between data donation, PANL and a new research app, the first large experiment with LISS households, and new methods for safely analysing population-wide networks. The main risks come from outside: new European rules could limit data donation, and skilled developers are hard to find.

Current status

4 of 6 recent data donation studies used D3I's standard templates

The Laboratory's tools are moving from research projects to services that researchers can rely on. The D3I data donation project set up a licensing arrangement that lets researchers in the Netherlands use its software for free, is signing agreements with universities, and is building a dedicated support team.

Researchers can now prepare data donation studies entirely through easy-to-use screens, and four of six recent studies used D3I's standard templates. Plans for a new research app were agreed with Centerdata and Utrecht University, and a product owner and community manager started in October 2026.

For online experiments, the first use case was completed, a second one on group deliberation was designed, and a secure online workspace for running experiments was built at SURF, with a first pilot in the LISS panel planned for late 2026.

PLANET-NL maintains free, open-source software for network analysis, which is reused around 160 times a year, and has released tools to check and reduce the risk that network data reveal individuals. It launched a City Network Science Lab with the municipality of Amsterdam, and two other national statistics offices are involved in creating population-wide network data.

Future plans 2027

Data donation as a full service

D3I is expected to be fully operational as a service and to reach agreements with more universities.

A major upgrade for data donation

New features will let participants share data more easily, keep some processing on their own device, donate photos and videos, and download a personal report about their own data.

Connected tools

Data donation, PANL and the new research app will be linked so participants can move smoothly between them.

A research app in practice

Two new data collection modules will be developed and tested with Centerdata, and the app will be promoted to researchers.

Better visibility

Data collection tools will be listed in the ODISSEI Portal and European catalogues, and an outreach campaign will include visits to institutions. Target: 10 data donation studies a year using ODISSEI's licences.

Online experiments open to all researchers

Early 2027

The online experiment workspace will become widely available early in 2027, with a support plan. A first large experiment will run with LISS households, a pilot will follow on PANL once it opens, and a call for experiments in the LISS panel will be published.

Ready-made building blocks

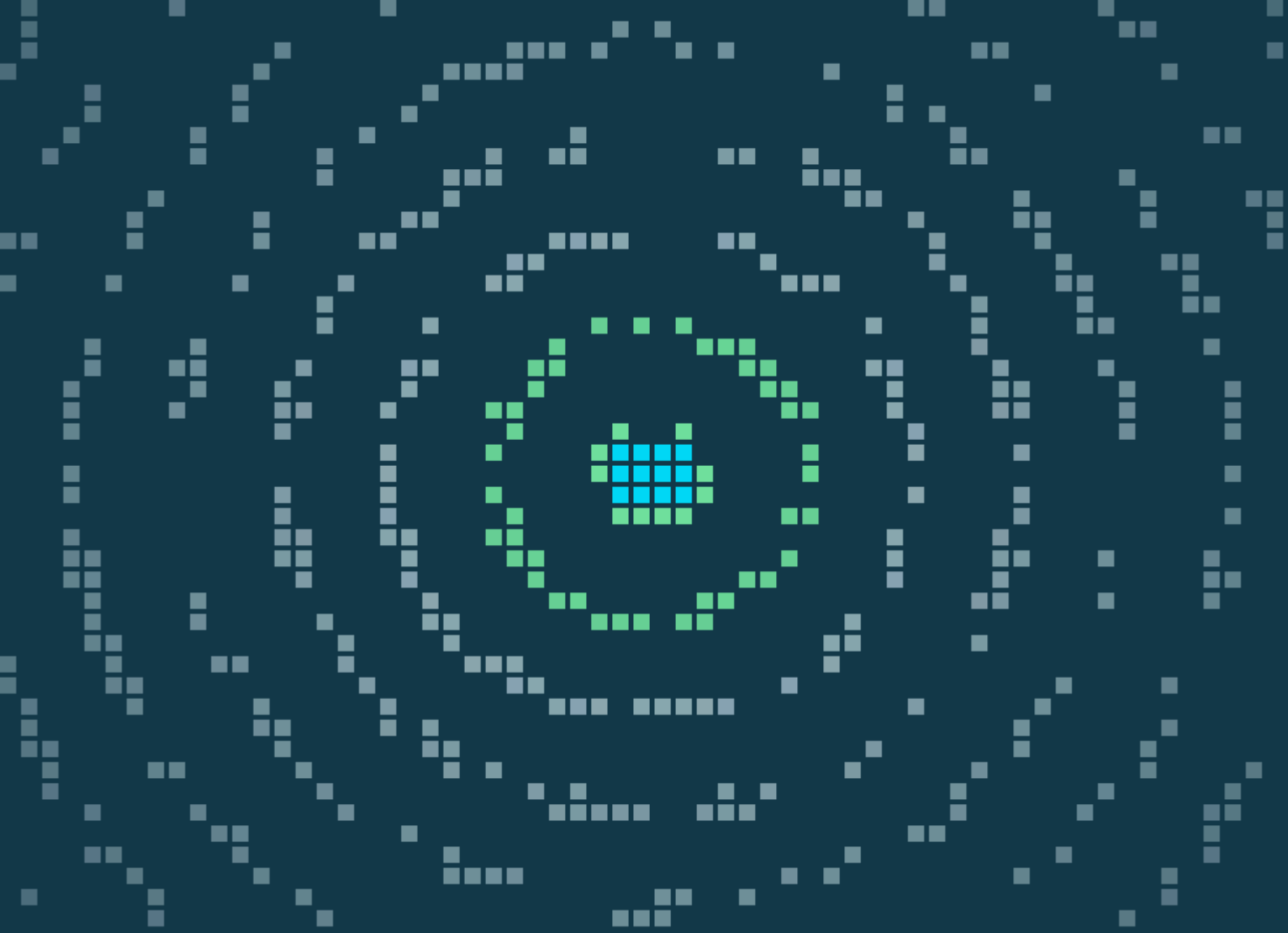
A first library of reusable experiment components will be released, and the team will explore AI assistants that help researchers build experiments.

Safer network research

PLANET-NL will develop methods that protect network data as well as ordinary tables, a visual tool for exploring networks on a map, and faster ways to find communities within very large networks.

From research to policy

The City Network Science Lab will grow into a broader policy lab, and community events will bring together researchers, policymakers and statistics offices.



Hub

The people behind the infrastructure

Data and tools matter only when researchers know they exist, can get help using them, and trust they are used responsibly. The Hub is where researchers find that help.

73
Grant applications in 2026: 27 microdata, 46 LISS

2 → 3
Social Data Science fellowships a year

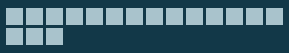
€2,542,505
Budget 2027, 25% of the total

Itemised budget 2027

€2,542,505

25% of ODISSEI's 2027 expenditure

Coordination and shared reporting
€848,569



Education and training
€469,769



Support: front desk, SoDa, ethics
€1,224,168



Planned 2027 expenditure is €2,542,505. Of these resources, €848,569 will support cross-infrastructure Coordination and shared reporting activities. €469,769 is directed towards educational activities, such as development and delivery of the training programmes or ODISSEI Summer School. Finally, €1,224,168 will finance a wide array of support activities, ranging from front desk support and SoDa team methodological support to ethical support.

About the Hub

Data and tools matter only when researchers know they exist, can get help using them, and trust they are used responsibly. The Hub is where researchers find that help. It answers questions, awards grants that provide access to data and computing, trains new users, offers guidance on ethical and legal questions, and coordinates ODISSEI-run projects.

The Hub has three parts. Support includes the ODISSEI front desk, access grants, fellowships and advice from the Social Data Science (SoDa) team, the FAIR Expertise Hub, which helps researchers make their data findable and reusable, and an ethics help desk. Education delivers summer schools, workshops, tutorials and training in computational social science. Coordination covers project management, governance, reporting, communication and events for the SSHOC-NL, Macroscope and PDI-SSH projects.

In 2026, the Hub formalised its work: support procedures were documented, a new system for tracking requests and usage (CRM) went live, and the ethics help desk was extended. Grant calls were popular, with 27 applications for microdata access and 46 for the LISS panel. In 2027, the Hub will measure its support for the first time, introduce one simple process for all access grants, set up an Ethics Forum that includes members of the public, and pilot a new skills curriculum that combines online self-study and in-person training. The main challenge is capacity: as the infrastructure grows, so does the scale of operations and support delivered.

Current status

20 early career researchers trained at the ODISSEI-SICSS Summer School

The Hub became more professional and better organised in 2026. Support procedures for SANE and the grant calls were documented, more than one person now has access to every help desk mailbox, and a new system for logging requests and usage (CRM) went live in August. ODISSEI now has 44 member organisations, including LUMC and the Netherlands Court of Audit, which joined in 2026. The grants continue to attract many submissions.

The SoDa team continued its fellowships and around 15 consultations a year, and contributed to projects such as NL-LENS, which models life courses using administrative data. The FAIR Expertise Hub published an action plan for better data practices and ODISSEI co-organised the CBS Replication Games, where 18 researchers investigated whether six published studies could be reproduced.

The ODISSEI-SICSS Summer School trained 20 early career researchers; ODISSEI held its first Early Career Day and a conference marking ten years of ODISSEI, and it organised its first Research Infrastructure Day with CLARIAH. On the coordination side, the 13 joint tasks were set up across the three projects run by the infrastructure, the Macroscope consortium agreement was signed, the task planning process was simplified, and the SSHOC-NL progress report for 2025 was approved by NWO.

Future plans 2027

Measuring support January

From January 2027, all support requests and usage activity will be recorded, so ODISSEI can monitor which facilities each member uses and how quickly researchers get an answer. Users will receive a short satisfaction survey when their grant, fellowship or SANE project ends.

Clearer information Twice a year

A guide for data stewards at member organisations will be published, with an online introduction twice a year, and a web page will clearly explain who can use SANE, the Portal, and the grants.

One simple process for all access grants

Applying for microdata access, LISS panel time, secure computing or expert support will follow one standard procedure, with short applications. Calls will be designed to reach early career researchers and disciplines that are not yet using the infrastructure much.

More expert help

The SoDa team will increase its fellowships from two to three a year and expand its consultations. The FAIR Expertise Hub will be strengthened with a dedicated position at the VU and will help more data providers join the secure data route.

An Ethics Forum with a public voice

A new Ethics Forum will include public representatives recruited through an open call. The ethics help desk will become easier to find and will be built into grant and SANE applications.

Practical guidance on hard questions

Written guidance will cover access by users outside academia, the use of AI with sensitive data, consent for data donation, standard agreements for data providers, and how to link survey participants to CBS and historical records. The data protection impact assessment for Macroscope will be completed.

Learning by doing

The ODISSEI Summer School will continue, along with workshops on topics such as AI in social science research and a second Research Infrastructure Day. The SoDa team will pilot two modules of a new skills curriculum.

Stronger user voice

The Early Career Board will continue advocating for early career researchers in the community. The Research Infrastructure Day will become a standalone annual event that brings together infrastructure providers and educators.

Smooth coordination and outreach

The Hub will continue to support the governance bodies, reporting to NWO and compliance across partners, with all task plans delivered on time. Communication and outreach activities will remain a core instrument in reaching the community.

A word from our community



Photo: ODISSEI

Elena Candellone at the ODISSEI Early Career Day, Utrecht, 4 November 2026

As of 2025, ODISSEI has established the Early Career Board to advocate for early-career scholars within the ODISSEI community. We asked the Board to share some of their ideas about ODISSEI and their own role.

Meet the Early Career Board →

> **"Without ODISSEI, early career researchers would miss affordable access to data, but also a national community of mentors and peers to learn from."**
>
> **Elena Candellone**
> ODISSEI Early Career Board

What is the main goal of the Early Career Board?

The goal of the Early Career Board is to understand and facilitate the needs of PhD candidates and postdocs of ODISSEI member organisations by organising events for networking, skills and career development. The Board comprises early career researchers from different institutions and scientific backgrounds. As we collaborate closely with ODISSEI and the ODISSEI Social Data Science Team, we can organise events and training tailored to the community's needs.

What do early career researchers need most at the start of their careers that infrastructure can provide?

A national infrastructure has a lot to offer in terms of data and expert support. With continuous exposure to those resources, the researchers can select the elements that fit their research projects. What early career researchers also need are good mentors and a community of peers. Mentors help researchers navigate methods, funding, and career choices, while a national network connects them with peers and shows them which career paths are open.

What advice would you give a PhD candidate or postdoc who is just discovering ODISSEI? What would early career researchers miss most if ODISSEI didn't exist?

The best advice I can give is to start engaging with the infrastructure early and ask for help navigating elements unfamiliar to you. Explore the data and facilities available to you, and come to an event to meet people working on similar problems. Without ODISSEI, early career researchers would miss affordable access to data, but also a national community of mentors and peers to learn from.

What is the board planning for 2027?

We will build on this year's Early Career Day with more skills workshops and networking events, as well as career events with speakers from academia, industry, government organisations, and NGOs. Our aim is to develop a network of early career scholars from different disciplines in the social sciences. The first event we hosted showed strong interest in connecting with others in adjacent disciplines, as well as in the mutual interests and challenges that researchers face.

If you have questions or suggestions for the Board, please reach out to earlycareer@odissei-data.nl.

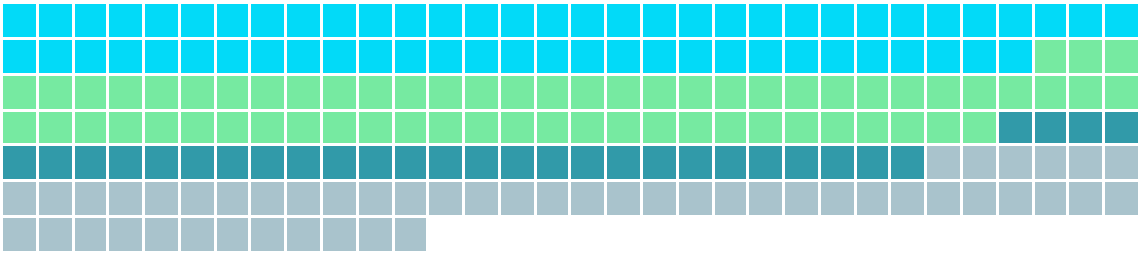
Financial plan 2027

Table 1 shows ODISSEI's planned expenditure for 2027. Because ODISSEI is one infrastructure rather than a collection of separate projects, the table is organised around ODISSEI's core tasks, which also structure the programme of work in this plan. For each task, the table shows the planned expenditure and the project or source that finances it.

All of the funding projects have been awarded and are currently under way. Membership fees are also used as co-financing for grant applications, which increases the funding available to the community.

The ODISSEI Coordination Team works closely with service providers to keep projects coordinated, avoid duplication and achieve efficiencies in implementation. The ODISSEI Management Board reviews the tasks in each project annually and adjusts their budgets to improve development and deliverables for the ODISSEI community.

Most tasks in SSHOC-NL and Macroscope are carried out jointly with CLARIAH, but a few concentrate on key investments in one community. The tasks led by CLARIAH, in which ODISSEI's involvement is limited, are not included in Table 1: tasks 2.3 and 3.2 in SSHOC-NL, and task 3.1 in Macroscope.



One square is about €50,000, rounded per task.

Data Facility		€3,052,182 30%
CBS microdata support		€478,696
Portal coverage and interoperability		€1,083,488
Secure computing on the OSSC		€523,337
SANE, incl. FIRMBACKBONE		€966,661

Observatory	€3,175,226	31%
Data collections: international surveys	€773,953	
Online panels: LISS and PANL	€1,882,410	
Netherlands Media Corpus	€518,913	
Laboratory	€1,494,504	15%
Data donation (D3I)	€697,597	
Mass online experiments	€176,146	
Large network tools (PLANET-NL)	€620,762	
Hub	€2,542,505	25%
Coordination and shared reporting	€848,569	
Education and training	€469,769	
Support: front desk, SoDa, ethics	€1,224,168	
Total	€10,264,417	

In 2027, ODISSEI's work is funded from several sources

- The ODISSEI core budget, including membership fees
- The PDI-SSH projects D3I, PANL, POPNET, SANE, FBB, FIP and EUR Coordination
- The LSRI upgrade Deepfield
- The SSHOC-NL and Macroscope projects
- MUW and CD2
- The EU projects AI4Social and CDIF4EOSC

Table 1. Planned expenditure per task and its funding, in thousands of euros

Workstream and task	2025	2026	**2027**	2028
Data Facility 4 tasks	1,451	2,842	**3,052**	2,715
CBS	234	604	**479**	283
SSHOC-NL 1.3 · Macroscope 1.3 · 2025 core CBS · 2026 core CBS · 2027 core CBS				
Portal	529	914	**1,083**	1,017
SSHOC-NL 4.1; 4.2; 4.3 · Macroscope 1.1 · Other projects CD2				
OSSC	220	411	**523**	416
Macroscope 1.2 · 2025 core SURF				
SANE	468	913	**967**	999
SSHOC-NL 1.1 · Other projects SANE, FBB · 2025 core UU-Rebo				
Observatory 3 tasks	1,060	4,447	**3,175**	2,418
Data Collection	560	2,157	**774**	582
SSHOC-NL 2.2 · Macroscope 2.1 · Other projects SHARE, ESS, TiU-ESS · 2026 core Data collection costs · 2027 core TiU				
Online Panels	500	1,823	**1,882**	1,343
SSHOC-NL 2.1 · Macroscope 2.2 · Other projects PANL, Deepfield · 2025 core Centerdata, RU-FSW · 2026 core Centerdata (LISS panel extension) · 2027 core Macroscope (Centerdata)				
Netherlands Media Corpus	0	467	**519**	493
SSHOC-NL 2.3, 3.2 (without UL)				
Laboratory 3 tasks	383	1,456	**1,495**	1,315
Data Donation	185	700	**698**	609
SSHOC-NL 1.2 · Macroscope 3.3 · Other projects D3I · 2027 core UvA (benchfees), Macroscope (UU)				
Mass Online Experiments	110	173	**176**	99
SSHOC-NL 3.3 · 2026 core Centerdata (oTree)				
Large Network Tools (POPNET)	88	583	**621**	607
SSHOC-NL 3.2 · Macroscope 3.2 (only UL) · Other projects Popnet · 2027 core UvA (benchfees)				
Hub 3 tasks	1,460	2,939	**2,543**	3,147
Coordination	566	1,150	**849**	1,046
SSHOC-NL 5.3 · Macroscope 4.1 · Other projects SBD, EUR PDI-SSH · 2025 core EUR · 2026 core EUR, VU				
Education	51	484	**470**	573
SSHOC-NL 5.2 · Macroscope 4.3 · 2026 core EUR				
Support	843	1,305	**1,224**	1,528
SSHOC-NL 5.1 · Macroscope 4.2 · Other projects FIP, MUW, FAIR, AI4Social, CDIF · 2025 core UU, EUR · 2026 core EUR, UU, TUD · 2027 core UU-FSW				
Total	4,354	11,684	**10,264**	9,595

Table 2. Revenues and structural funding, in thousands of euros

	2025	2026	2027	2028
Core Revenues	1,640	2,153	834	829
Core Expenditures (included in Table 1)	1,353	2,101	800	493
Annual Surplus	287	52	34	336
Cumulative Surplus	287	339	373	709
Structural Funding	1,054	2,791	2,292	2,287
Ongoing Funding	3,302	8,893	7,972	7,308
Structural Funding as %	24.19%	23.89%	22.33%	23.84%

Key performance indicators

ODISSEI's scope has changed over the past year. The award of Macroscope and Deepfield, together with ODISSEI's growing role in EU proposals, means the infrastructure now covers a larger and more varied portfolio than our current KPI table was designed for. Rather than adding rows to that table, we propose to monitor ODISSEI through eight questions, each answered by one indicator with its current status and a 2027 target.

Highlighted values are still being set.

1 Is ODISSEI being used?

Active projects

Now

125 projects

2027 target

+25% projects

Currently there are around 125 active projects in 2026. This comprises 67 projects running in SANE, 10 funded projects using the CBS microdata, 9 projects running on the OSSC, 28 projects using the LISS panel, 3 SoDa fellowships and 8 data donation studies using PORT. Our target is 25% growth (156 projects) in 2027 and will be primarily achieved through increased access to sensitive data via SANE.

2 Is data access getting easier?

Percentage gaining access to data within 10 working days from access request to a working SANE environment

Now

33% for 2026

2027 target

80% for 2027.

We measure the percentage of proposals which receive access within 10 days of requesting data or by the date as set by the researcher. In 2026, this was achieved for 33% of proposals and our target is 80% for 2027.

3 Is the impact growing?

Publications, citations, and policy impact of supported projects

Now

71 publications in 2026, 24 OpenOverheid mentions, 2,798 cumulative citations.

2027 target

+20% in each area

We track the impact of the projects we support in science and policy, and are tracking media impact fully as of 2027. Currently, supported projects have produced 71 publications in 2026 (January to October) and 24 separate documents have mentioned ODISSEI or related work in OpenOverheid. Cumulative citations to ODISSEI-related work now stand at 2,798. Our target is 20% growth in each area through 2027.

4 Is ODISSEI sustainable?

Structural funding share and members committed for the long term

Now

22.33% structural; 31 of 44 members committed to 2031

2027 target

20% structural; 44 of 44 members committed to 2035 by end of 2028

Sustainability rests on structural funding, reserves within the 5% rule, and members committing for the long term. Currently, structural funding is 22.33% of the budget and 31 of 44 members have committed until 2031. Our target is at least 20% structural funding and 44 of 44 members committed through 2035 by the end of 2028 as part of the next LSRI application.

5 Is there strategic alignment?

CBS, SURF, DSW, DEB, and the SSH-Raad to be actively consulted on the strategic work programme annually

Now

4 of 5 were consulted in 2026

2027 target

All 5 (including SSH-Raad)

CBS, SURF, DEB, DSW, and the SSH-Raad shape our data, computing and policy environment, and their governance should support ODISSEI's work. In 2026 we formally reported to and consulted 4 of the 5 on a shared strategic roadmap. Our target is to repeat this with all 5 in 2027.

6 Are users engaged?

Yearly participation in ODISSEI activities

Now

587 unique participants

2027 target

+15% participation; 40% returning

We measure engagement as the annual unique participation in ODISSEI activities, such as the conference, summer school, workshops and SoDa consultations. In 2026 this was 587 (not including IPDLN). As of 2027, we will also track the number of users who return to use a service or attend an event within two years of initial contact in order to better measure retention. Our target is at least 40% retention and 15% more participants by 2027.

7 Is ODISSEI positioned internationally?

International proposals joined each year and their success rate

Now

3 proposals in 2026, 67% success

2027 target

3 a year, 33%+ success rate

International projects such as CDIF4EOSC, AI4Social, and TRELISS can bring influence in European research infrastructure. In 2026, ODISSEI joined 3 proposals with a 67% success rate, securing €419,000. TRELISS was unsuccessful. Our target is at least 3 proposals a year, each linked to our mission and strategic goals, with a success rate of 33% or higher.

8 Are members getting value?

Investments in services per euro of membership fees

Now

€670,000 brings in €7,972,000

2027 target

At least €10 returned for every €1 invested

Membership fees are used as co-financing for grant applications, so each member's contribution brings in more research funding than it could alone. Currently, €670,000 in fees brings in €7,972,000 in grants, a ratio of 1:12. Our target is to maintain at least 1:10. The membership fee provides a signal of commitment to NWO who explicitly aim to stimulate and multiply these investments by the research sector.

Governance

ODISSEI is the Dutch National Infrastructure for Social Science and provides access to a federated set of services to ODISSEI member organisations. Its mission is to enable researchers to leverage comprehensive data, computing power and expertise for studies that shape policy and society.

Through ODISSEI, researchers have access to large-scale, longitudinal data collections as well as innovative and diverse new forms of data. These can be linked to administrative data at Statistics Netherlands (CBS). Combining data from a wide range of sources enables researchers to answer new, exciting, interdisciplinary research questions and to investigate existing questions in novel ways. ODISSEI now consists of 44 member organisations.

Supervisory Board

The Supervisory Board consists of seven members. Claes de Vreese (DSW, Chair), Viola Angelini (DEB), Hanneke Imbens (Statistics Netherlands), Helga de Valk (KNAW/NWO institutes and E-infrastructures), Susan Branje (DSW), Maarten van Ham (DSW), Paulette Flore (Public research institutes).

Management Board

The Management Board consists of eleven members and meets monthly to discuss and evaluate the programme of work. Daniel Oberski (UU, Chair), Tom Emery (EUR, Executive Director), Jessica Piotrowski (UvA), Marcel Das (Centerdata), Ran van den Boom (Statistics Netherlands), Annette Langedijk (SURF), Carlos Martinez Ortiz (NLeSC), Patris van Boxel (DANS), Jacco van Ossenbruggen (VU), Gert Stulp (RUG), Ioulia Ossokina (TU/e).

Coordination Team

The Coordination Team runs ODISSEI day to day. Tom Emery (Director), Kasia Karpinska (Scientific Manager), Theodora Canciu (Project Manager), Ellen Schlebusch (Tech Lead), Evgeniia Krichever (Communications Manager), Angelica Maineri (Data Manager), Tadas Bernotas (Junior Data Manager).

International Advisory Board

An International Advisory Board has been established. Julia Lane (New York University), Melinda Mills (University of Oxford), Sally Wyatt (Maastricht University), Amy O'Hara (Georgetown University).

Better infrastructure.
Better research.
Better society.

ODISSEI